With the augmentation of the Swadeshi fleet by the addition of the *Lawoe*, SSNCo was looking forward to having a daily service between Tuticorin and Colombo and giving BI a tough fight.[101]

There was euphoria in the Swadeshi camp. VOC had pulled off what was considered impossible. Subramania Bharati, welcoming the arrival of the steamers with a cartoon,[102] likened India's joy to that of a mother being suddenly blessed with two children after a long period of barrenness (Figure 9). By accomplishing this task, he said, VOC and his friends had fulfilled their duty to their motherland in full.[103] Despite his unconcealed joy, the idealist in him did not rest. Bharati wondered if the steamers would carry alien names even after they had passed into Swadeshi hands. Arguing for rechristening them, he proposed that they be named after the medieval warrior-chief Shivaji, the modern nationalists Tilak and Naoroji, or the progressive Gaekwad, prince of Baroda.[104] Evidently, this idea did catch on and even the police was reporting the possibility of the *Gallia* being called *Swadeshi* and the *Lawoe*, *Swaraj*.[105] No doubt VOC shared these views, but given the life and death struggle that SSNCo faced in its short career, there was little time to carry out such idealist designs. In any case, changing the names would have been a long-drawn process involving time and money.

The *Swadesamitran* was no less triumphant when it wrote:

> When the formation of such a company was first proposed, the Feringhees laughed the idea to scorn. But God has been on our side, and the company is now firmly established. This has engendered impatience and envy in the minds of the Feringhees, who, in cooperation with Mr Waller, are endeavouring to crush the company. Swadeshi lectures are prohibited; the sale of tickets in the bazaar by the company is prohibited. When Indians desire to counsel their brother Indians to encourage this Indian movement, why should the Feringhees object? Let the Feringhees travel in Feringhee steamers and leave the Swadeshis to travel in Swadeshi steamers. There ends the affair … It is possible that the whole energy of the Feringhees is now directed to getting into scrape Chidambaram Pillai, the pillar of this company, in the hope that, if he be put out of the way, the company itself will shortly go out of existence?'[106]

Another paper, the *South Indian Mail* wrote: 'Despite carping critics and pseudo-patriots, this national concern continues to thrive wonderfully; and